



CM Storm introduces Sentinel Advance gaming mouse with an OLED display

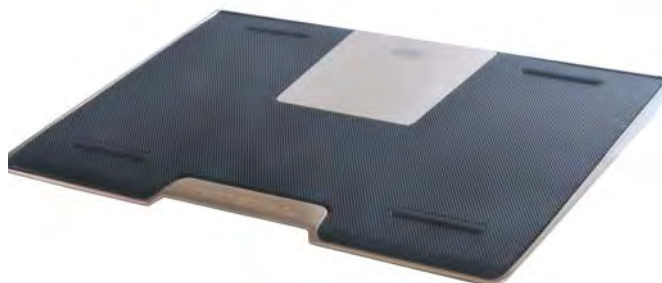


Creative launches the Zen Mozaic EZ300 media player in 4 GB and 8 GB capacities

CoolerMaster NotePal Color Infinite

A breath of fresh air

The 'color infinite' name tag probably refers to the variety of colours this notebook cooler is available in. From sober greys to a pastel pink; the colours add much of the style element to this sleek notebook cooler. We got a golden mat finish piece which was certainly nice looking. To see how effective it was at cooling, we used one of the slightly more hotter running laptops. We let 3DMark06 run to heat up the system and gauged temperatures with and without the cooler. The laptop chassis definitely was less hot while on the cooler. The groove pattern visible through the mesh is designed for optimum air flow. The fan takes in air through the back intake and pushes it through the mesh. The pattern is such that you get a smooth flow of cool air underneath your palms. The fan runs very silent and sans vibrations on all



three speed settings. It draws power through a USB port and compensates for it by providing another one on the cooler body. Additional features include hooks on the back panel of the cooler to manage wires as well as guide grooves on the bottom for the same. In terms of usage scenarios, you can use this on your lap, bed as well as on a desk. The mesh has stoppers to prevent slipping and in fact the whole aluminium body is anti skid. The cooler's

angle perfectly compensates for the downward gradient of normal sitting posture. The four rubberised knobs the bottom however can get irritating. Its footprint is quite large (as much as a 17-inch notebook) but it's quite lightweight; weighing in at 700 grams. Laptop coolers are certainly a niche line of products and so can command that inflated pricing. At Rs. 2,300 this one may still be worth a buy but a little cheaper and buying it would've been a no brainer.

Contact

Cooler Master
Phone: +91-94225-01592
Email: Tanmay_L@coolermaster.com
Web site: www.coolermaster.com
Warranty: 1 Year Replacement
Price: Rs. 2,300

Specifications

Dimension: 380 x 300 x 10-50 mm
Weight: 700 g
Fan Dimension: 90 x 90 x 25 mm
Max Fan Speed: 2000 rpm

RATINGS

Features6
Performance7.5
Build Quality7
Value for Money5
Overall6.5

APC Back-UPS RS 550

Small fry

Contact

Elizabeth Jacob
Phone: +91-80-39872000
Email: elizabeth.jacob@apcc.com
Web site: www.apc.com
Price: Rs. 2,475

Specifications

Battery: 12V, 40 Watts/5min
Frequency: 45-65 Hz
Dimensions: 18.55 x 11.5 x 31.3 cm
Surge protection: 160 Joules
Weight: 5.1 kg

RATINGS

Features6
Performance5.5
Build quality7
Value for money6
Overall6

This is a UPS that is positioned as a battery backup and surge protection solution for business desktops. It has a rating of 550 VA which comes out to an output capacity of 300 Watts. Therefore it can easily handle basic home or office systems. Gaming systems are slightly out of reach for this UPS since gaming rigs would require a more beefier output capacity. To test the UPS we ran it on a standard office set up to check runtime on battery and also to check if the switch to battery is seamless. The documentation boasted of a 36 minute backup time, but it delivered 7 minutes. The two output ports available are standard 3-pin (India) 6A;

both have surge protection. In terms of features there aren't many as compared to some UPSs nowadays that come with an LCD screen to display status and change settings. There is however a resettable circuit breaker in case the UPS shuts down due to an overload. There's an alarm when output is on battery and a distinctive low battery alarm. The UPS has three sensitivity settings which can be used in case you find it switching to battery power too often. Sensitivity settings can also be used specific to the equipment connected to it. For instance equipment that cannot handle even minor voltage waveform distortions can be put on the 'high' setting which operates between a



limited spectrum of 165 to 270V. However switching between the sensitivity settings is difficult since you need to operate with just one button. Still, at Rs. 2,475, it's not extremely expensive and as an utility that gives you enough backup time to save all your work, it's well worth the money.